Teaching notes and solutions

Teacher notes

Use two different parameters to compare two lines. Check all three coordinates, even if two suffice to calculate candidates. A Cartesian equation on its own generally describes a plane in space; it does not describe a line. Reuse the projection from Chapter 11 to give meaning to the solving of systems.

Solutions to the activity

1. A point of d_1 has coordinates (t,t,t). It belongs to the plane if and only if $3t=3$, that is $t=1$. The intersection is therefore the single point $(1,1,1)$.
2. For a point of d_2, $x+y+z=3+t-t+0=3$ for every t. All points of the line are in the plane: $d_2 \subset \mathcal{P}$.
3. For a point of d_3, $x+y+z=t-t+0=0$. The equation $0=3$ has no solution: the line is disjoint from the plane. Its direction vector $(1,-1,0)$ is orthogonal to the normal $(1,1,1)$; it is parallel to the plane.
4. After substitution, we obtain respectively an equation with a single solution, an identity true for every parameter value, and a contradiction. These three cases correspond to a single intersection point, containment, and no intersection.

E1. $\overrightarrow{AB}=(2,1,-1)\neq\vec{0}$. The line therefore has the representation $(x,y,z)=(1,-1,2)+t(2,1,-1)$, $t\in\mathbb{R}$. The values $t=0$ and $t=1$ give back A and B.

E2. For $A(1,2,3)$, the condition $\overrightarrow{AM}\cdot(1,0,-2)=0$ is $(x-1)-2(z-3)=0$. After expanding, the plane has equation $x-2z+5=0$. The point A satisfies it.

E3. After substitution, $t+2(1+t)+(2-t)=8$, that is $2t+4=8$, so $t=2$. The unique intersection is $(2,3,0)$; we check $2+2\times3+0=8$.

E4. The second equation gives $x=y$. Let $x=y=t$; the first becomes $2t+z=1$. The set of solutions is $(x,y,z)=(t,t,1-2t)=(0,0,1)+t(1,1,-2)$, a line.

E5. The normals are collinear, the second being twice the first. But doubling $2x-y+z=3$ gives $4x-2y+2z=6$, which is incompatible with the right-hand side 5. The planes are therefore strictly parallel, not intersecting.

Solutions to Homework 12

1. The coefficients of x, y, z give the non-zero normal $\vec{n} = (1, 2, 2)$ in the orthonormal frame.
2. Look for H on the normal line through M: $H = (3 + t, 2t, 2t)$. Membership of $\mathcal{P}$ gives $3 + t + 4t + 4t = 9$, so $t = \frac{2}{3}$. Thus $H = (\frac{11}{3}, \frac{4}{3}, \frac{4}{3})$. We check $\frac{11}{3} + \frac{8}{3} + \frac{8}{3} = 9$ and $\overrightarrow{MH} = (\frac{2}{3})\vec{n}$. So H is indeed the orthogonal projection, and $MH = (\frac{2}{3})\sqrt{1 + 4 + 4} = 2$.
3. The normals $(1, 2, 2)$ and $(1, -1, 0)$ are not collinear: the planes meet along a line. Since $x = y$, let $x = y = s$. The first equation gives $3s + 2z = 9$, that is $z = \frac{9-3s}{2}$. The intersection is the line $(x, y, z) = (s, s, \frac{9-3s}{2})$, $s \in \mathbb{R}$.
4. The point H has $x_H = \frac{11}{3} \neq \frac{4}{3} = y_H$, so it belongs neither to $\mathcal{Q}$ nor to the line of intersection.
5. The cote is the z-coordinate. Setting it to zero requires $9 - 3s = 0$, so $s = 3$ and $K = (3, 3, 0)$. Then $MK = 3 > 2 = MH$. This result is consistent with the property of the orthogonal projection: among all points of the plane, H is the closest to M.

Solutions to the textbook or past-paper work

1. True: the line passes through B and its direction vector $(-2; -1; 3)$ equals $-\frac{1}{2}\overrightarrow{AB}$.
2. False: $\vec{n} \cdot \overrightarrow{OB} = 15 - 4 - 1 = 10 \neq 0$.
3. False: for $k = -4$ and $s = \frac{5}{2}$, the two representations give $(11; 12; -14)$. The lines intersect, so they are coplanar.
4. True: $d(C, \mathcal{P}) = \frac{|2-(-1)+2+1|}{\sqrt{1+1+1}} = 2\sqrt{3}$.